ZERO TRUST ACCESS DESIGN CLINIC — PROCTOR ONLY

ZTA Proctor Guide

Reference answers (cheat sheet) + scoring rubric for each use case, integrated. **Do not show to participants.**

How scoring works. Each use case = **100 points** (40 / 30 / 30). Grade each team's submission against the reference answer; award partial credit generously where intent matches. Leaderboard score = sum across submitted use cases. Use Cases 1–3 are required, 4–5 are bonus.

Scoring rubric (applies to every use case)

CRITERION	MAX	WHAT EARNS THE MARKS
Pain-point → product mapping	40	Each customer pain point is mapped to an appropriate Cisco product/feature that genuinely addresses it. Full marks = every pain point covered with the right platform and a clear reason; partial credit per pain point matched.
Products — how & why / differentiators	30	For each product: a correct one-line "how it works" and a convincing "why it fits". Cisco differentiators earn the top of the band.
Diagram & overall solution	30	Diagram is legible, labels the groups/zones, marks enforcement point(s), traces a flow end-to-end; overall solution is coherent and satisfies the requirements within budget.

Use Case 1 — Managed Environment — Segmentation

Required 100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Prior segmentation failed. VLANs/IP subnets complex and tedious.	Implement SGTs over VLAN/IP subnets.
Profiling labour-intensive; staff can't keep up with new devices.	ISE cloud AI profiling.
Failing PCI audits.	Apply SGT for segmentation and insert FW services where L7 security is required.
Corporate PCs not running latest AntiVirus / OS updates.	Use ISE Posture and remediate out-of-date PCs.
No budget for more firewalls to do segmentation.	Use SGTs to enforce segmentation within the wired/wireless network.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
ISE	Authenticate and profile every user and device (web, 802.1X, MAB).	Visibility and scalable.
ISE-SGT	Assign an SGT to each group (Employee, IoT, Desktop-mini, Internet).	Cisco innovation; dynamic policy, topology-independent; end-to-end segmentation into multicloud data centers.
ISE SGT ACL policy	Granular access policy.	SGACL more efficient than IP ACLs.
ISE pxGrid	pxGrid / Rapid Threat Containment; shares context with the ecosystem.	Cisco innovation, RFC8600; dynamically quarantines threat devices; integrates with ACI, FW, SNA, SD-WAN, CSW, switches, routers.
Catalyst SD-WAN	pxGrid integration for unified security policy via C3 / Security Cloud Control.	Consistent policy across the WAN fabric.
FMC / SCC / FTD	Threat detection/protection (NGIPS, malware, content filtering) and source/dest SGT policy enforcement.	Integrates with ISE via pxGrid for Rapid Threat Containment; dynamic SGT-based enforcement.

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Cisco Secure Workload	App Dependency Mapping; profiles flows and builds app-segmentation policy; ingests NetFlow from FTD; pxGrid/ISE connector.	Auto policy creation, validation and enforcement based on identity + posture from ISE/pxGrid.

Score sheet

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100

Use Case 2 — Remote Workers — Zero Trust Access

Required | 100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Full client VPN over-permissive; not Zero Trust.	Cisco Secure Access (SSE) ZTNA — per-app, least-privilege access; retire broad VPN.
Manual daily VPN; low user satisfaction.	Cisco Secure Client with always-on / seamless ZTNA (transparent access).
Too many sign-ons per application.	Single sign-on via Cisco Duo SSO (SAML/OIDC) across apps.
Want to eliminate password logins / stolen credentials.	Duo passwordless (FIDO2 / passkeys) and phishing-resistant MFA.
Okta IdP too expensive.	Use Duo as the SSO/IdP to reduce Okta reliance and cost.
Controlled internet — block gambling and gaming.	Secure Access SWG + DNS-layer security (Umbrella) content categories.
Contractors need private-app access from unmanaged devices.	Secure Access clientless ZTNA (browser-based RDP/VDI).
Modernize branches; reduce branch cost.	Catalyst SD-WAN + Secure Access = SASE; converge networking and security.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Cisco Secure Access (SSE)	ZTNA (client + clientless), SWG, DNS-layer security, CASB, FWaaS — one cloud, one agent.	Per-app least-privilege replaces broad VPN; single converged SSE.
Cisco Duo	MFA, passwordless (FIDO2/passkeys), SSO; can act as IdP.	Phishing-resistant; reduces sign-ons and Okta cost.
Cisco Secure Client	Unified agent: ZTNA + VPN + posture in one client.	Seamless UX; always-on access, no manual VPN.
Catalyst SD-WAN	Branch fabric integrated with Secure Access for SASE.	Modernizes branches and lowers cost.

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Umbrella / DNS security	Content filtering (gambling/gaming) and DNS-layer protection (in Secure Access).	Fast, category-based control everywhere.

Score sheet

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100

Use Case 3 — AI Access and Agent Controls

Required

100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Shadow AI usage today.	Cisco Secure Access CASB + app discovery — identify and report AI apps in use.
Users granted rights equally; need fine-grained control.	Identity-based policy (Duo/ISE groups) with Secure Access ZTNA per user/group.
Only corporate ChatGPT tenant allowed.	Secure Access SWG tenant restrictions (header injection) to force the corporate tenant; block personal logins.
Users expose sensitive data to GenAI.	Cisco AI Defense + Secure Access DLP inspect prompts/uploads to GenAI.
Claude Desktop agents / local MCP agents on employee systems.	Cisco AI Defense guardrails + Secure Access egress controls for agent traffic.
Too many unknown MCP servers in private & public DCs.	Cisco Secure Workload / Hypershield discover MCP flows; allow-list and enforce at runtime.
Personal credentials for ChatGPT.	Duo SSO + tenant restriction — block non-corporate identities.
Downloading risky AI models.	Secure Access SWG malware/file inspection + AI Defense model validation to block risky sources.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Cisco AI Defense	Discovers AI usage, inspects prompts/responses, enforces guardrails, validates models.	Purpose-built GenAI safety and agent guardrails.
Cisco Secure Access (SSE)	CASB (shadow-AI discovery), SWG tenant restrictions, DLP, egress control.	One place to see and control AI access for remote users.
Cisco Duo	Identity for tenant restriction, blocks personal creds, SSO.	Ties AI access to corporate identity.
Cisco Secure Workload / Hypershield	Discover and control MCP-server flows and agent egress; runtime enforcement.	Sees and segments unknown agent/MCP traffic in the DCs.

Score sheet

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100

Use Case 4 — Merger & Acquisition — Extend Segmentation

Bonus 100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Unsure how to extend segmentation to acquired company.	Cisco TrustSec — propagate SGTs across sites (inline SGT / SXP over SD-WAN); consistent SGACL policy from ISE.
Only selected branch users → restricted resource (Site 9951).	SGT-based SGACL that permits only the selected group to the Site 9951 resource; enforced at FTD / switch.
Not ready to add 100 staff to the corporate directory; use what they have.	Federate the acquired Okta IdP to Cisco ISE / Duo (SAML) — keep Okta short-term, no re-provisioning.
Minimize disruptive authentication during transition.	Identity federation + SSO (Duo) — seamless access to corporate apps.
Acquired company breached; still using passwords.	Duo MFA + passwordless (FIDO2/passkeys) for acquired users immediately.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Cisco ISE	Central identity + SGT policy; federate the acquired Okta IdP; posture.	One policy source; reuses existing Okta.
Cisco TrustSec (SGT)	Extends segmentation across sites, topology-independent; SXP / inline SGT.	Fast to extend; no re-subnetting.
Cisco Secure Firewall (FTD)	Enforces SGT policy at the acquired-site edge; restricts Site 9951 resource.	Already on site; reuse for enforcement.
Cisco Duo	MFA / passwordless + SSO federation for acquired identities.	Immediately hardens breached, password-based users.
Catalyst SD-WAN	Carries SGT / segmentation between the sites.	Consistent policy over the WAN.

Score sheet

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100

Use Case 5 — Zero Trust across Multicloud Data Center

Bonus 100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Minimal visibility of apps across multicloud.	Cisco Secure Workload App Dependency Mapping — auto-discover apps and flows on-prem + AWS + Azure + Kubernetes.
Lacking a segmentation strategy/plan.	Secure Workload auto-generates and validates microsegmentation policy before enforce.
Kubernetes latency and visibility issues.	Cisco Hypershield (eBPF) for low-latency K8s workload visibility and enforcement.
Need app run-time protection; minimize blast radius.	Hypershield runtime protection + autonomous segmentation.
Unable to patch IoT devices.	Hypershield virtual patching / compensating controls; segment IoT.
Too many disparate management interfaces.	Cisco Security Cloud Control — unified policy across on-prem + multicloud enforcement points.
Limited budget; leverage native features.	Cisco Multicloud Defense — native cloud enforcement + virtual appliances (FTDv) where needed.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Cisco Secure Workload	App Dependency Mapping + microsegmentation policy across on-prem, AWS, Azure and Kubernetes.	Visibility-driven, validated policy; end-to-end segmentation.
Cisco Hypershield	eBPF runtime protection, autonomous segmentation and virtual patching (K8s and unpatched IoT).	Low-latency, self-updating enforcement in the workload.
Cisco Multicloud Defense	Native multicloud enforcement with virtual appliances; consistent policy across AWS/Azure.	Leverages native features; budget-friendly.
Security Cloud Control (SCC)	Single pane to manage policy across on-prem and multicloud enforcement points.	Cuts disparate management interfaces / complexity.
Secure Firewall (FTDv)	Virtual firewall enforcement where L7 controls are needed.	Reuse where native controls aren't enough.

Score sheet

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100

Zero Trust Access Design Clinic — Proctor Guide (confidential).